

2023" at Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, the "ITB-2023" at Berlin, Germany, the "India International Trade Fair (IITF)" New Delhi, the "Vaikunda Ekatasi Festival" at Trichy, the "IATO-2022" at Lucknow, celebration of "Pongal Festival-2023" in all districts of the state are some important events in which the state participated in a big way. Events such as the "Travel and Tourism Bazaar-2022" at Ranchi, the "Rajaraja Cholan Sathaya Vizha-2022" at Thanjavur, the "9th Annual Global Organization of Tamil Origin Meet and 15th Annual Edison Awards" at Chennai, the "Heritage Walk" at Gingee Fort, Viluppuram, the "Margazhi Village Festival" at Dakshinchitra, Chennai, the "Tamil Nadu International Balloon Festival" at Pollachi are among noteworthy events sponsored by the state tourism department. The Tamil Nadu Tourism won laurels for its outstanding initiatives which includes "the Best Tourism Minister of the Year-India" and "Destination of the Year—Heritage" at PATWA Awards, ITB Berlin. The classical, folk and tribal artists of the state were provided several platforms to showcase their artistic and creative skills to the world augmenting their earnings. Among the mega events in which the artists performed were "Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat" held in Jammu and Kashmir costing Rs.19 lakhs, the Tamil diaspora commemorated the 75th anniversary of the oldest Indian community in Malaysia, at a cost of Rs.13 lakhs. The calendar event, Margazhi music festival was held at seven regional cultural centres of the Department of Art and Culture at a cost of Rs.15 lakhs, the World Tamil Day celebration 'Kalaivanar Arangam', at Chennai, 'Chennai Sangamam – Namma Ooru Thiruvizha' a grand folk arts cultural festival was inaugurated by the CM Stalin at 18 venues in Chennai where 1000 folk artists performed incurring a cost of Rs.5.62 crores, Tamil Nadu's classical dance form Bharathanatyam and Periyamelam instrumental music programmes were conducted at the World Economic Summit and 9th World Tamil Economic Conference held in Dubai, performances were held at the 9th Ilamtamizhar literary workshop held at Madurai World Tamil Sangam, during World Heritage Week, January 2023, cultural events were held at Madurai, Tanjore, Mamallapuram and Tranquebar at a cost of Rs.6.50 lakhs, spectacular cultural programmes were conducted at Chennai and Mamallapuram during the G20 education and Finance work group meetings at

a cost of Rs.21 lakhs. To encourage private cultural organizations, a grant of Rs.11.90 lakhs was disbursed to seven of them.

Several up-gradation and renovation work was carried out by TTDC in its hotels and restaurants, one pontoon and adventure sports equipment such as a Jet Ski at Boat House, Valankulam were procured, besides AC sleeper and chair buses were operated connecting big cities other than Chennai and taking necessary steps to organize Jain Circuit Temple Tour.

On his visit to the office of the Commissioner (Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments), CM Stalin released 108 replenished version of antiquated Spiritual books, opened a book stall and distributed appointment orders on compassionate grounds to beneficiaries and also ordered hike in pay to 354 temporary Teaching and non-Teaching Staff working in Colleges and Schools run by Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowment Department. He also provided Rs.3 Crores assistance to 88 temples coming under the management of Tanjore Palace Devasthanam.

Funds were also allocated for renovating the Heritage Museum Theatre at a cost of Rs.3.00 crores, besides 3D Laser Projection Mapping for the National Art Gallery through TTDC at the cost of Rs.4,56,00,000 and another Rs.50 lakh is being spent on upgrading the Chemical Conservation Laboratory at Government Museum, Chennai.

During the celebration of the World Heritage Week, 2022 many Archaeology and Epigraphy awareness programmes, workshops, competitions, lectures, training, etc., were held for the benefit of scholars, researchers, students and the general public at all the site museums and sub-offices of this Department. CM Stalin visited the 2nd season's excavation conducted at Gangaikondacholapuram and a special exhibition was organized with the artefacts unearthed from the Archaeological sites at the books fairs held in Sivagangai, Tirunelveli, Coimbatore, Dharmapuri, Erode, Karur and Virudhunagar. Training and workshops were conducted for the Archaeological Officers in the field of marine archaeology and geo-surveys in collaboration with Indian Maritime University [IMU] experts and eminent scholars of Archaeology.

Enchasing the gift of nature's abundance, which



is a substantial revenue generator, the Tamil Nadu government has rolled out several development and infrastructure projects conforming to the Green guidelines for ease accessibility to many legendary tourist spots. An amount of Rs.1134.56 lakhs has been sanctioned for the Development of Coutrallam Waterfalls, whereas for giving a facelift to the Development of Muttom Bay and Thirparappu Falls, Rs.715.06 lakhs has been sanctioned. Even the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) has been roped in for loans to the tune of Rs.223 lakhs towards amenities of Vathalmalai, Rs. 400 lakhs for the development of Muthupettai Mangrove forest and Rs. 306.31 lakhs to Development of Muthukuda as tourist destinations with various facilities.

Loans amounting to Rs.177.83 lakhs has been sanctioned for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report to establish a "Nandavanam" at ECR, Chennai, Rs.4406.00 lakhs for the Construction of a world-class Jallikattu arena at Alanganalur, Madurai, Rs.2360.00 lakhs has been sanctioned for the Renovation of Poompuhar Heritage City and a sum of Rs. 1407 lakhs to Upgrade Pichvaram Boathouse with various tourist amenities.

Special Fund sanctions:

- Rs.595.00 lakh spent on construction of Multipurpose Indoor Stadium at District Sports Complex, Theni.
- Rs.778.80 lakh allocated to build a Boxing Academy at Gopalapuram, Chennai
- Rs. 50.85 crore sanctioned for conducting the "Chief Minister's Trophy" for the year 2023.
- Rs.8,25,00,000 spent on relaying of synthetic athletic track at District Sports complex, MGR Stadium, Madurai.
- Rs.50.00 lakh earmarked to build Weightlifting Training Centre at Paramakudi in Ramanathapuram District.
- Rs.85.60 lakh for construction of Tennis Court and construction of Gym Hall in District Sports Complex, Karur District.

